

“The required technology is not available. Though teams have gone abroad to see the Thames and Seine, it would take another seven-eight years for the Yamuna to become like any of these rivers.”

SHEILA DIKSHIT, Delhi Chief Minister

RAJESH BHAMBHI

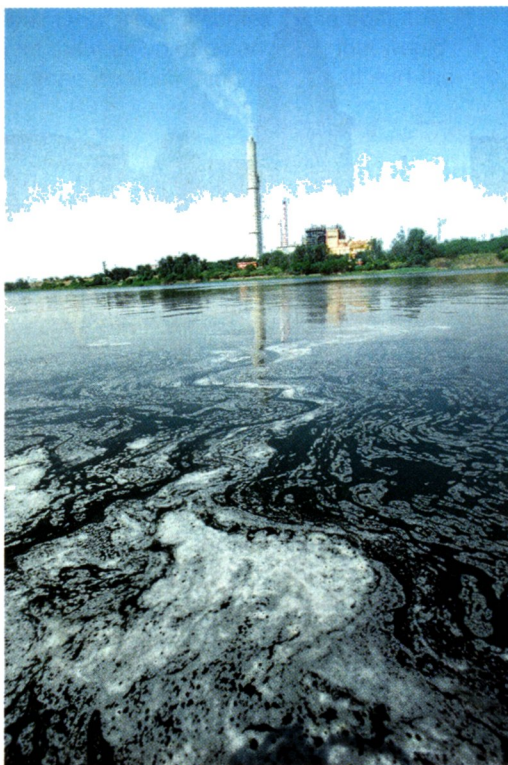


Rs 1.5 crore, only two rivers out of the 37 (the Narmada and Mandovi) are now deemed clean. But the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) contradicts itself while making the claim that these two rivers are “not polluted now”, as it itself gave the BOD of 11.4mg/litre for the Narmada at Hoshangabad and 4.7mg/litre for Mandovi at Tonca, Goa.

An INDIA TODAY investigation into the NRCP's entire misadventure, for which more than 30 applications were filed under the RTI Act, has revealed its failure as authorities like the CPCB still say our rivers are dirtier than they used to be. Two decades of failure around the Ganga project led Minister of State for Environment and Forests Jairam Ramesh to admit in Parliament that the quality of the Ganga and Yamuna is as bad as it was 20 years ago. The reason, he said, was that the pollution load, “has increased much beyond our expectation. The sewage treatment plants have not been

THE CHAMBAL

Rs 3.58 crore has already been spent on it since it came under the NRCP in 1995. Almost 50 km of the 425-km Chambal is polluted; it's the filthiest at Kota, Rajasthan.



PURUSHOTTAM DWIVAKAR / www.indiatodayimages.com

THE SATLUJ

Rising from beyond Indian borders in Tibet, the Satluj is no more than a drain as it crosses Punjab where it is dirtied by the industrial and urban pollution of 12 major cities

RS 1.5 CRORE HAS BEEN SPENT TO CLEAN UP EVERY POLLUTED KILOMETRE.